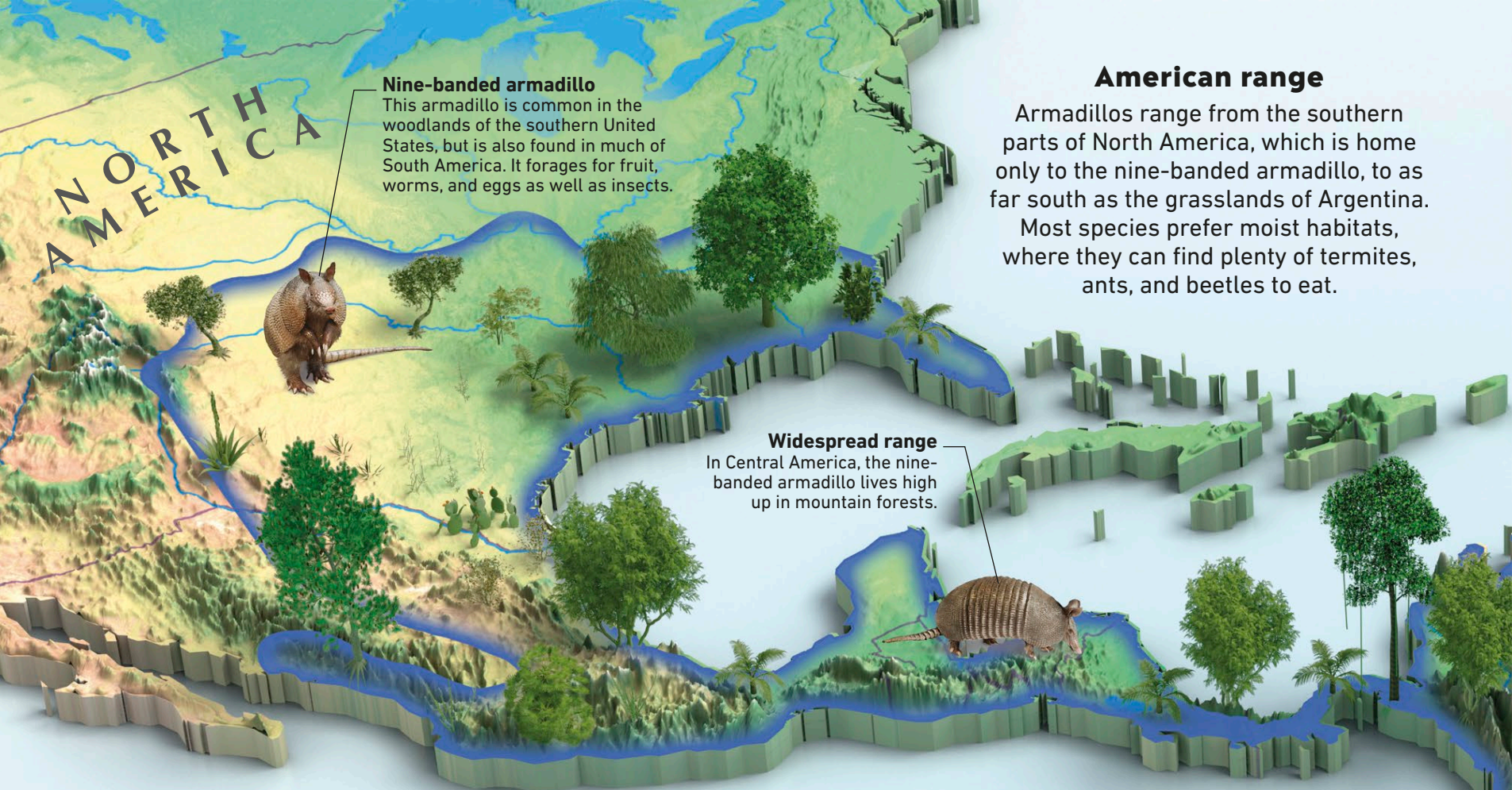




Nine-banded armadillo

This armadillo is common in the woodlands of the southern United States, but is also found in much of South America. It forages for fruit, worms, and eggs as well as insects.

American range

Armadillos range from the southern parts of North America, which is home only to the nine-banded armadillo, to as far south as the grasslands of Argentina. Most species prefer moist habitats, where they can find plenty of termites, ants, and beetles to eat.

Widespread range

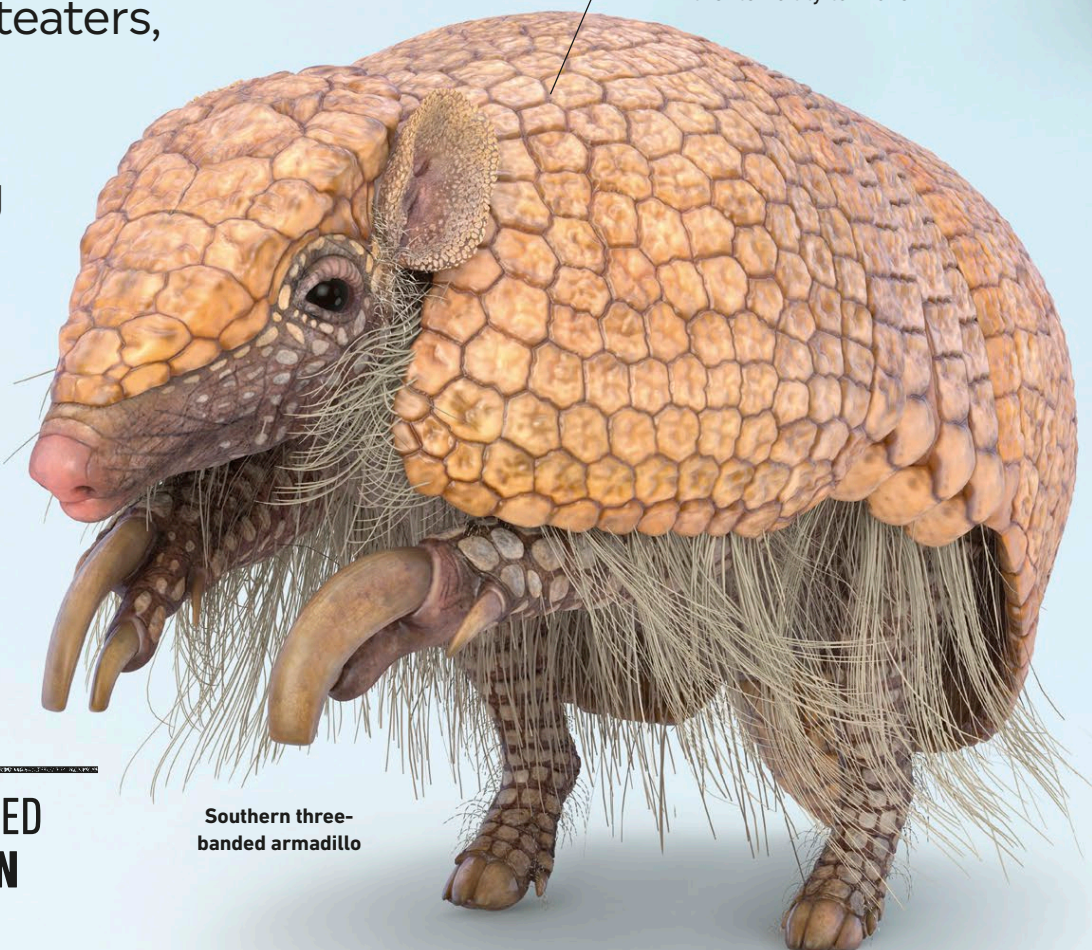
In Central America, the nine-banded armadillo lives high up in mountain forests.

Armadillos

Closely related to sloths and anteaters, these armored mammals are found only in the Americas and nowhere else. Of the 21 existing armadillo species, five are shown here. They are the only mammals with bony armor, and they use their heightened sense of smell and long, sticky tongue to catch insects and other small animals.

Bony armor

The armor of an armadillo is made up of bony plates covered with tough, horny skin. The plates are connected loosely to give the body the flexibility to move.



Southern three-banded armadillo



WHEN STARTLED, THE NINE-BANDED ARMADILLO MAY JUMP MORE THAN 3 FT (1 M) INTO THE AIR